

Wheeled Troop Carriers

Wheeled personnel carriers have become popular since the end of the Cold War, especially 8x8 vehicles. Automotive developments have given them cross-country mobility similar to tracked vehicles, and wheels remain more reliable and durable than tracks. The ability of wheeled vehicles to self deploy over long distances, without needing transportation, was demonstrated in Mali in 2013. Wheeled vehicles also have a greater resistance to mines and IEDs—most modern 8x8s can be driven even with multiple destroyed wheels.

▽	XA-185
Date	1994
Country	Finland
Weight	14.9 tons (13.5 tonnes)
Engine	Valmet 612 DWI diesel, 246 hp
Main armament	12.7 mm NSV machine gun

The first XA series vehicle, the XA-180 was introduced in 1984. The XA-185 had a more powerful engine. Further upgrades led to the XA-186, XA-188, and the larger XA-203, which were no longer amphibious. XA vehicles have been sold to Finland, Norway, Sweden, Estonia, and the Netherlands. Besides peacekeeping missions, the XA-185 has been used in Afghanistan.



△	Pandur I
Date	1995
Country	Austria
Weight	14.9 tons (13.5 tonnes)
Engine	Steyr WD 612.95 diesel, 260 hp
Main armament	.50 Browning M2 machine gun

The 6x6 Pandur I is used by Austria, Slovenia, Kuwait, and Belgium. Some were also supplied to the US Special Operations Command. The Belgian vehicles are used for reconnaissance, and some Kuwaiti vehicles are armed with a 90 mm gun. The upgraded Pandur II, in 8x8 configuration, was made available from 2005.

▷	Piranha III
Date	1998
Country	Switzerland
Weight	24.3 tons (22 tonnes)
Engine	Caterpillar C9 diesel, 400 hp
Main armament	Varies

The Piranha III has been sold to more than 12 countries, with variants ranging from standard Armored Personnel Carrier (APC) to electronic warfare and assault gun. The Canadian variant, LAV-III, is used by Canada and New Zealand, and forms the basis of the US Army's Stryker family.



△	ASLAV
Date	1992
Country	Australia
Weight	14.8 tons (13.4 tonnes)
Engine	Detroit Diesel 6V53T diesel, 275 hp
Main armament	25 mm M242 cannon

Based on the USMC LAV-25 and the Canadian Bison, a total of 257 ASLAV vehicles were purchased in two configurations. The nonturreted personnel carrier hull can be converted to command, surveillance, or ambulance using removable kits. The ASLAV has seen service in Iraq and Afghanistan.



△	Type 96
Date	1995
Country	Japan
Weight	16 tons (14.5 tonnes)
Engine	Komatsu diesel, 360 hp
Main armament	.50 Browning M2 machine gun

The Type 96 has a two-man crew and space for eight infantrymen, who get in and out using a rear ramp or five roof hatches. It has two firing ports on each side. Although never exported, the Type 96 was used by the Japanese Iraq Reconstruction and Support Group between 2004 and 2006.

